

Password and Account Policy

Version 3.2 · Owner: IT Department · Review: annually

1. Purpose

This policy sets the rules for passwords, accounts and access rights for all company systems.

2. Password rules

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long. Passphrases made of several unrelated words are encouraged. Passwords must be changed every 180 days, and immediately if you believe a password has been exposed. The last 10 passwords cannot be reused.

3. Account logout

An account is locked after 5 failed sign-in attempts. A locked account unlocks automatically after 15 minutes. If you need access sooner, call the service desk, who will verify your identity before unlocking it.

4. Multi-factor authentication

MFA is required for email, the VPN and every system that holds Confidential or Restricted data. The company authenticator app is the only approved method.

5. Shared accounts

Shared accounts are not permitted. Every person must use their own named account so that actions can be traced to an individual.

6. Requesting access

Access to shared drives, applications and groups is requested through an access request ticket. The request must be approved by your line manager, and for Restricted systems also by the system owner.

7. Privileged access

Administrator and other privileged access is reviewed every quarter. Privileged accounts are separate from everyday accounts and must not be used for email or web browsing.

8. Leavers

When an employee leaves, their accounts are disabled by 18:00 on their last working day. Managers must raise the leaver ticket at least 3 working days in advance.